

**GOVERNMENT OF INDIA  
MINISTRY OF COMMUNICATIONS  
DEPARTMENT OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS**

**RAJYA SABHA  
UNSTARRED QUESTION NO. 1297  
ANSWERED ON 31<sup>ST</sup> JULY, 2025**

**INITIATIVES TO ENSURE UNIVERSAL MOBILE AND BROADBAND  
CONNECTIVITY**

**1297 SHRI R. DHARMAR:**

Will the Minister of Communications be pleased to state:

- (a) the current status of Government's initiatives to ensure universal mobile and broadband connectivity, particularly in rural, tribal, and border regions of the country;
- (b) whether there are still significant gaps in telecom infrastructure, such as unconnected villages, poor mobile network coverage, and lack of high-speed internet access in Aspirational Districts and remote areas;
- (c) the steps being taken to accelerate rollout of 4G and 5G services, improve call quality and internet reliability, and reduce urban-rural digital divide; and
- (d) whether Government has conducted any independent assessments of service quality and how it plans to improve accountability of telecom service providers?

**ANSWER**

**MINISTER OF STATE FOR COMMUNICATIONS AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT  
(DR. PEMMASANI CHANDRA SEKHAR)**

(a) to (d) As of May 2025, out of 6,44,131 villages in the country (as per data of Registrar General of India), 6,29,027 villages have mobile coverage. Out of these, 6,23,512 villages have 4G mobile coverage, including rural, tribal and border regions of the country.

Mobile coverage for any uncovered inhabited villages is provided by the Telecom Service Providers (TSPs) based on the techno-commercial viability. Government, through funding from Digital Bharat Nidhi (DBN), is implementing various schemes for expansion of telecom connectivity through installation of 4G mobile towers in the rural, remote and border areas of the country, including Aspirational districts. As on June 2025, 21,748 sites have been commissioned in the country under DBN funded mobile schemes.

BharatNet project is being implemented in a phased manner to provide connectivity to all the Gram Panchayats (GPs) for broadband services, such as Wi-Fi Hotspots, Fibre to the Home (FTTH) connections etc. Further, the Union Cabinet has approved Amended BharatNet Program for provisioning of connectivity to all GPs in the country in ring topology including upgrading existing network and connectivity to about 3.8 Lakh non-GP villages on demand basis. As of June 2025, 2,14,325 GPs have been made service ready under BharatNet project in the country.

The Government has taken several initiatives to improve network connectivity and quality of service. These include:

- Assignment of sufficient spectrum for 4G and 5G services through auction.
- Notification of Telecommunications Right of Way (RoW) Rules, 2024 and launch of PM GatiShakti Sanchar portal to streamline RoW permissions and expeditious clearance for installation of telecom infrastructure.
- Notification of “The Standards of Quality of Service of Access (Wireline and Wireless) and Broadband (Wireline And Wireless) Service Regulations, 2024” by TRAI, prescribing revised QoS parameters and their benchmarks for both access and broadband services.

TRAI conducts assessment of service quality through independent drive tests (IDT) in different regions across the country. The IDT reports are published on TRAI website for information of consumers and shared with the service providers for remedial action.

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